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COMPSCI 160  
Summer 2026  
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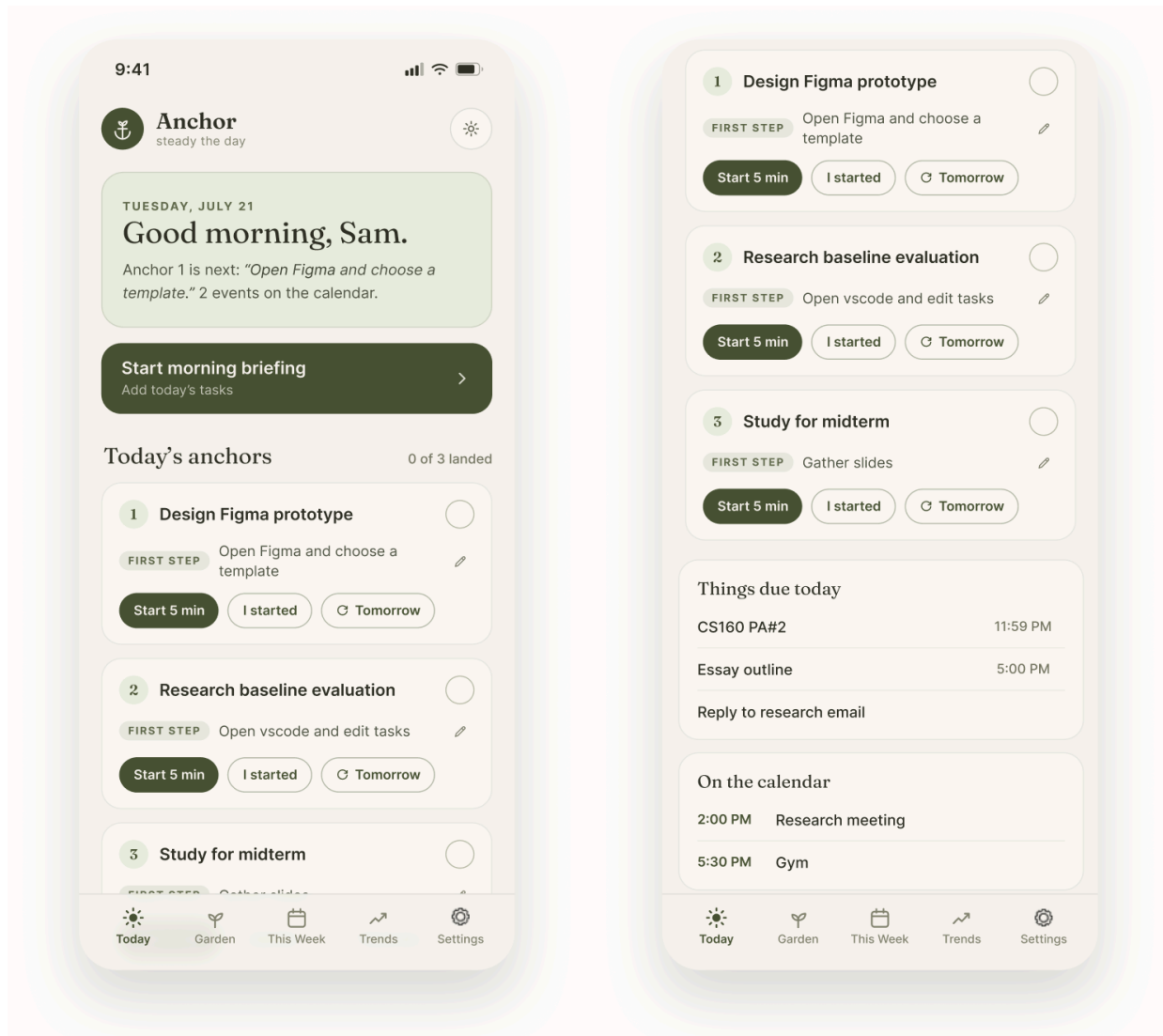
## Project Milestone 3: A High Fidelity Prototype

### 1) Hi-Fi Prototype of single page

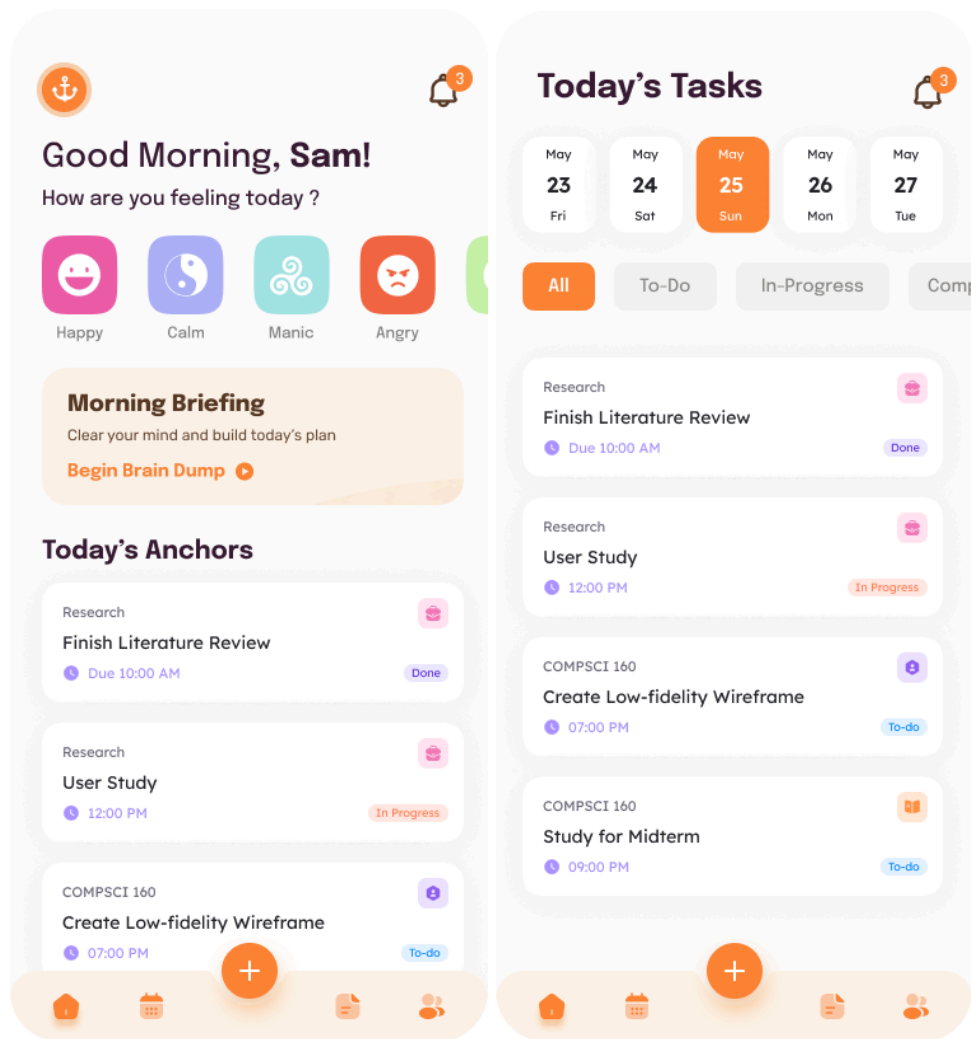
Design 1 – V1 + V2 (Made by Na Mi):



## Design 2 (Made by Sampurn):



### Design 3 (Made by Madison):



## 2) Critique Session with Group

### Design 1 (Made by Na Mi):

Positive critique:

- Well-structured organization of tasks with the first step clearly displayed.
- Navigation bar icons are easy to distinguish.
- Strong emphasis on the three main tasks, reducing cognitive overload

Negative critique:

- Green and yellow color scheme feels somewhat jarring.
- Lacks a help or documentation section.
- Unclear which page is currently active because no navigation icon is highlighted

### Design 2 (Made by Sampurn):

Positive critique:

- Cohesive color palette using sage greens and neutral tones creates a calming, wellness-focused aesthetic
- Effectively supports breaking tasks into smaller steps and clearly communicates user progress
- Navigation icons combine symbols and text, improving clarity and discoverability.

Negative critique:

- The “Start 5 Minutes” and “Tomorrow” pills are unclear in purpose
- Small text, particularly in the welcome section, reduces readability
- “Add Today’s Tasks” is not clearly distinguishable from the “Start Morning Briefing” button

### Design 3 (Made by Madison):

Positive critique:

- Cohesive color palette with a clean, light interface.
- Centrally placed floating "+" button makes adding tasks intuitive.
- Clear task filter bar (All, To-Do, In Progress, Completed) supports efficient task management.

Negative critique:

- Notification badges can be visually distracting.
- The morning screen begins with multiple colorful mood reflection icons, which may compete for attention.
- Missing key productivity features such as task breakdowns, focus/sprint sessions, and the ability to check off completed tasks.

### **Why we selected design 2:**

We selected Design 2 as our direction because it best aligned with our goal of helping overwhelmed students with mental health conditions manage their workload in a calm, approachable way. We thought the cohesive color palette would ensure a calming aesthetic and could be applied if we implemented the Growth Garden, which is one of our stretch goals. We also thought this design emphasized breaking larger tasks into smaller, more manageable steps with a visual anchor for focus time, which we hope to keep for our future prototype. For the next iteration, we plan to address some usability issues like improving the clarity of the “Start 5 Minutes” and “Tomorrow” buttons. We also wanted to create a stronger visual distinction between the “Add Today’s Tasks” and “Start Morning Briefing.”

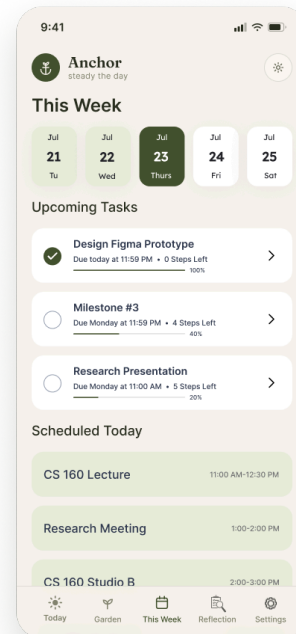
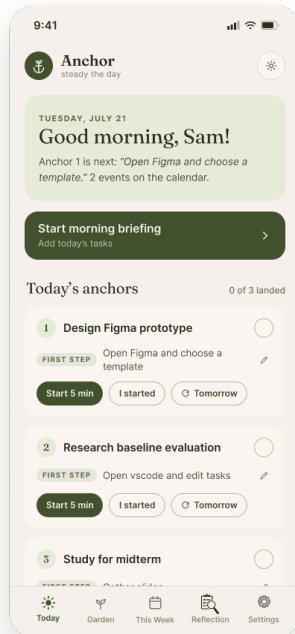
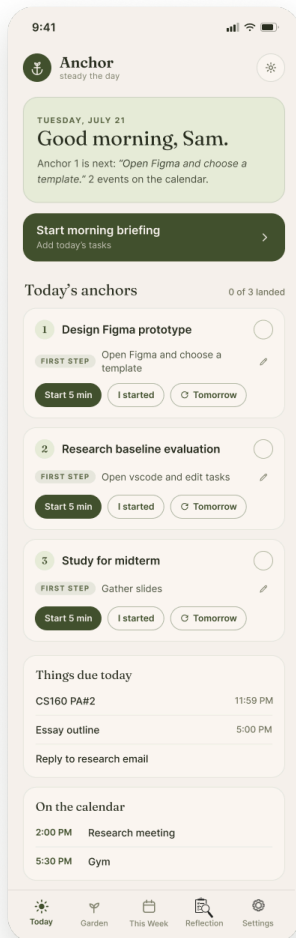
### **3) Hi-Fi Prototype (Figma)**

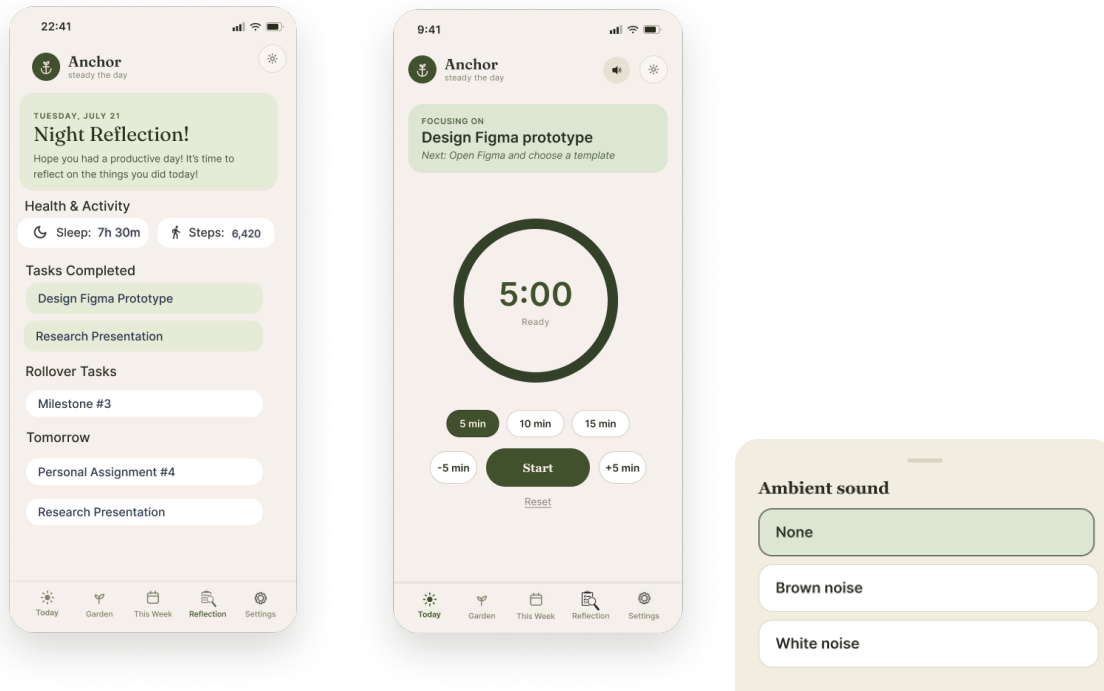
Link to Prototype:

<https://www.figma.com/design/1gJt2z5PtBEJMhIZtZ9dQI/Anchor-App?node-id=0-1&t=N69csgtwng1NummG-1>

Prototype Authors:

- Initial Screens: Sampurn
- Timer + Ambient sound choices: Na Mi
- This Week: Madison
- Night Reflection: Thanhbinh





## 4) Critique Session with External Participants

Participant A (Interviewed by Thanhbinh):

- Pro: Enjoys the sleep and steps feature
  - “I love how it includes sleep and steps in the night reflection makes it so every essential is kept together”
  - Suggested: Water reminder and tracker.
- Pro: Easy to distinguish colors between week’s activities and plans
  - “ Very beneficial for separating tasks but keeping them together”
- Pro: Likes the different ambient sound options, and encourages to try to add other sound options.
  - “More options for ambient noise? Maybe the sounds of oceans?”
- Pro: App was thoughtfully organized.
  - “The font sizes on everything can be read clearly”
- Con: We can only add time with increments of 5 minutes only.
  - “I’m gonna assume that all tasks are added at 5 minutes but maybe a scroll option like a time bar or input so you don’t have to keep adding 5 minutes.”
  - Suggested: Time bar or user input field
- Con: Restricted to having a green color palette UI.
  - “Green is nice but some people might want different colors”
  - Suggested: Customizable colors
- Con: Unclear description for morning welcome message
  - “Morning description confusing ‘anchor 1 is next’ assuming it’s the ui name? Anchor?”

Participant B (Interviewed by Thanhbinh):

- Pro: Pretty design
  - “Definitely the design, it feels calming”
- Pro: Easy “to cooperate with”
- Pro: Enjoys the timer functionality
  - “I really like that you put a timer in it”
- Con: Unsatisfied with night description
  - “I think the message in the night reflection bar should be changed”
- Con: Limited ambient sound options.
  - “There are too little sounds to choose from”
- Con: Prefers if there are reflection questions to wrap up the day
  - “I’d add some mood questions”

Participant C (Interviewed by Thanhbinh):

- Pro: Pretty design
  - “I like the minimalist design, nothing playful”
- Pro: Concise design
  - “Very clear, just as much text as needed”
- Pro: Pretty shape choice
  - “The rectangles with rounded corners just look very elegant”
- Con: Sad color palette:
  - “I’d personally choose a color that’s just a little less sad (?) nothing too vibrant though but that’s just personal taste”
- Con: Inconsistent fonts
  - “I’d stick to one font only”
- Con: Limited colors:
  - “It’s a huge deal maker or breaker for me.”
  - Suggested: Customizable colors

Participant D (Interviewed by Thanhbinh):

- Pro: Detailed subtexts
  - “I like the small labels you used”
- Pro: App was thoughtfully organized and designed
  - “With the dates, I like how easy it is for me to navigate and distinguish what it was for me.”
- Pro: Versatile app
  - “I like how the sleep hours and steps are combined in one app, because on my phone I have to use two different apps” is combined with different features (sleep + steps)
- Pro: Pretty color palette
- Con: Finished tasks aren’t easy to distinguish
  - “Cross out tasks when it’s done”
- Con: Lack target due date
  - “For the assignments, it would be nice to add due date time for assignments so they have a target due date”

- Con: Unclear rollover task
  - “If possible, I would expand more on the rollover tasks”

#### Participant E (Interviewed by Reed):

- Pro: Easy to understand interface
  - Action: Task list was the first element that caught their attention and helped communicate the purpose of the application.
  - “I like that there’s a focus timer because users can add time and decide how long they want to focus.”
- Pro: Pretty design
  - Enjoys the overall color palette and visual design
  - Attracted to the application because it looks clean and easy to use.
- Pro: Clear and concise design
  - Action: Thinks the colors fit well with the style commonly used in mindfulness and time-management applications.
  - Action: Thinks the interface looks sleek and easy to use.
  - Action: Says the text and font sizes are easy to read.
  - “The opening page immediately shows the user’s day-to-day information rather than beginning with a list of general actions.”
- Con: The logo and the meaning of the word Anchor were confusing.
  - Suggestion: “I would add a clearer explanation, tagline, or visual connection between the name ‘Anchor’ and the application’s purpose.”
- Con: Fuzzy interactions with tasks:
  - Action: Unclear where the tasks came from or how they were generated.
  - Action: Sometimes unclear what each task referred to, although this may have been because the prototype was not fully functional.
  - Suggested: Clearly identify whether each item comes from Gmail, Calendar, or manual entry.
- Con: Lack of details
  - Action: Expected the application to clearly show tasks, meetings, and deadlines.
  - Action: Expected clicking on a task to open additional information and display the task’s details.
    - Suggested: Add an expanded task-details view.
  - Action: Expected to mark a task as complete using a dedicated completion button or by deleting it.
    - Suggested: Add a clear completion control and an option to remove tasks.
- Con: Green color palette UI is not unique.
  - “The color palette looks good but does not feel especially unique compared with other mindfulness and productivity applications.”

#### Participant F (Interviewed by Reed):

- Pro: Appealing layout
  - Action: Likes the layout and visual design.



- “The buttons are clear and visually appealing because of their rounded shape.”
- “I feel that the interface is organized and easy to understand.”
- “The clean layout makes the application approachable.”
- Pro: Nice color choice
  - “I like the use of green in the interface”
- Pro: Useful features
  - “The active check-ins from the application would be helpful.”
- Con: Sad color palette choice
  - “I feel the green color palette alone may not fully communicate the intended energy or purpose of the application.”
  - Suggested: “Consider adding blue to communicate trust or yellow to create a more energetic feeling.”
- Con: Lack of call-to-action from logo
  - “The logo does not appear sufficiently intentional or customized to the application.”
  - Suggested: Redesign the logo so that it feels more curated and directly connected to the application’s purpose.
- Con: Lack of target due date for current day
  - Tasks scheduled for the current day do not indicate how much time remains before they should be completed.
  - Suggested: “I would add a time tracker or remaining-time indicator to each scheduled task.”

### 3 Recurring Themes

#### Theme 1: Participants wanted more visual customization (5 of 6 participants)

- a. “Green is nice, but some people might want different colors” – Participant A
- b. “I’d personally choose a color that's just a little less sad.” – Participant C
- c. Regarding customizable colors: “It's a huge deal maker or breaker for me.” – Participant C
- d. Critiques of “The color palette looks good but does not feel especially unique compared with other mindfulness and productivity applications.” – Participant E
- e. “I feel the green color palette alone may not fully communicate the intended energy or purpose of the application.” – Participant F
- f. Next Iteration: Our next iteration will explore personalization options with multiple color schemes to allow users to tailor the app to their preferences

#### 2. Participants wanted a more flexible focus timer and wellness features (4 of 6 participants)

- a. “I really like that you put a timer in it.” – Participant B
- b. “I like that there’s a focus timer because users can add time and decide how long they want to focus.” – Participant E
- c. “Maybe a scroll option like a time bar or input so you don't have to keep adding 5 minutes.” – Participant A
- d. “More options for ambient noise? Maybe the sounds of oceans?” – Participant A

- e. “There are too few sounds to choose from.” – Participant B
- f. Next Iteration: We plan on making the focus timer customizable by allowing users to enter their own focus duration or quickly choose preset lengths. We also plan on expanding the ambient sound library.

**3. Theme 3: Some text and interactions were unclear or restrictive? (5 of 6 participants)**

- a. “Morning description confusing Anchor 1 is next.” – Participant A
- b. “I think the message in the night reflection bar should be changed.” – Participant B
- c. “For the assignments, it would be nice to add due date time for assignments.” – Participant D
- d. “I would add a time tracker or remaining-time indicator to each scheduled task.” – Participant F
- e. “If possible, I would expand more on the rollover tasks.” – Participant D
- f. “Cross out tasks when it's done.” – Participant D
- g. “I'd stick to one font only.” – Participant C
- h. Next Iteration: We plan on revising our “Today” home screen to improve text clarity, standardize typography, make completed-task states more visually distinct, add assignment due dates, and better communicate how rollover tasks work. We want to ensure the interface is more intuitive to help students organize their tasks and understand what to do next.

## 5) App Name + Logo + Tagline + Description

**App Name:** Anchor

**Logo** (image author: Sampurn):



**Tagline:** Steady the day

**Description:** To help users to overcome the feeling of overwhelm and help them to start doing tasks more easily and less stressfully by pulling tasks directly from email and calendar, and choosing 3 priority steps for the day.

# 6) Development Plan

Sheets:  Anchor Implementation Plan

| Anchor Development Plan, Sun 7/26 to Fri 7/31                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Day                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Task                                                                                                                                  | Who                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Hours | Dependencies               | It's done when                                                                | Status      |
| Sun (7/26)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Set up the repo and vite react app with 5 tabs                                                                                        | Sampurn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 3     |                            | Everyone can open it and click the tabs                                       | Completed   |
| Mon (7/27)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Auth + hosted DB (sign-up, login, logout, and database-connected), Settings page, Customizing color                                   | Thanhbinh                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4     |                            | Add a task, refresh, it's still there                                         | Not started |
| Mon                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Stylesheet from the Figma (colors, fonts, logo, cards), Customizing color palette                                                     | Nami                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 3     |                            | A sample card matches the Figma                                               | Not started |
| Mon                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Vercel connect / Auto deploy git repo                                                                                                 | Sampurn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 1     | Repo setup                 | live link                                                                     | Not started |
| Mon - Tue                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Google Cloud OAuth setup and Connect Google button: Calendar events + Gmail as tasks                                                  | Madison                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 4     |                            | Realistic tasks and events load (start with sample data)                      | Not started |
| Tue-Wed (7/28-7/29)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Today screen (greeting, anchors, due today, calendar) + check-off                                                                     | Sampurn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 5     |                            | Looks like the Figma, tapping a circle updates '0 of 3 landed'                | Not started |
| Tue-Wed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Start Morning briefing (review email/calendar items, add tasks, pick top 3)                                                           | Madison                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 4     | Google cloud OAuth         | Finishing it fills Today's 3; selecting Gmail shows only gmail tasks          | Not started |
| Tue-Wed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Reflection screen + rollover tasks (unfinished anchors show up in tomorrow's briefing)                                                | Thanhbinh                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 5     | hosted DB                  | Shows what got done, typing 'essay' suggests a tiny first step                | Not started |
| Tue-Wed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Focus timer (timer should show up as a popup when leaving screen) + first-step suggestions                                            | Nami                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 4     |                            | Timer runs down and the session is saved                                      | Not started |
| Mon-Wed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | This Week screen (Start weekly briefing, 7-day strip, selected-day task and event filtering, task details, empty/loading/error states | Reed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 5     |                            | Scrollable week overview, select a day, view that day's tasks and events,     | Not started |
| Thu (7/30)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Morning and evening notification settings, permission handling, reminder scheduling, and test notification                            | Reed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 4     |                            | users can enable notifications, choose briefing and reflection times, receive | Not started |
| Thu                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Garden screen: plant grows when you land anchors                                                                                      | Sampurn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 4     | Base screens setup         | Landing anchors grows the plant                                               | Not started |
| Thu                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Ambient sound in the timer - Whites noise / Brown noise / Cafe / Rain sound                                                           | Nami                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 3     | Focus timer                | Sound plays                                                                   | Not started |
| Thu                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | User manual PDF                                                                                                                       | Thanhbinh                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2     | Base screens setup         | complete user manual                                                          | Not started |
| Thu                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Full run-through of the whole loop                                                                                                    | Madison                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 1     | All core features complete | Briefing → timer → check off → reflect works with no dead ends                | Not started |
| Thu - Fri (7/30 - 7/31)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | feature testing and stress testing report (2 feature tests + 5 stress tests per person)                                               | Everyone                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 5     |                            | complete testing report                                                       | Not started |
| Fri (7/31)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Put the app online, test on a phone, URL of the prototype                                                                             | Sampurn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 1     |                            | Working live URL                                                              | Not started |
| Fri                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Submit implementation document                                                                                                        | Thanhbinh                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 1     |                            |                                                                               | Not started |
| Fri                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | AI coding tool-use Google form                                                                                                        | Everyone                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 1     |                            |                                                                               | Not started |
| STRETCH Goals, once everything above works                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Spoken morning briefing                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5     |                            | Play button reads the plan aloud                                              | Not started |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Meta Glasses connect                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5     |                            | Auto morning bricing and notification in meta glasses                         | Not started |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Phone widget home screen                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5     |                            | Home screen showing the next anchor                                           | Not started |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Garden screen extend with more plants                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5     |                            |                                                                               |             |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Web app version                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Parallel Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                       | Potential Bottleneck                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| We split up the work so the individual pages can be done in parallel. So styling, authentication, Google OAuth integration, and development of the Today, This Week, Reflection, and Focus Timer screens can be completed simultaneously after the repository is configured |                                                                                                                                       | Google OAuth and Calendar/Gmail integration are prerequisites for the Morning Briefing feature. We are also worried about finalizing Hi-fi designs before full front-end implementation                                                                                                                                                                                               |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Outside Constraints                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                       | Workload Distribution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Sampurn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Summer Research, another summer class                                                                                                 | Workload was determined based on experience and areas of interest for growth. Sam focuses on application architecture and deployment, Madison implements Google integrations and the Morning Briefing experience, Nami develops UI styling and focus features, Thanhbinh works on persistence and the Reflection flow, and Reed develops the weekly planning screen and notifications |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Madison                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Summer Research, another summer class                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Nami                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Applying for jobs                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Reed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 17 units, job, overlapping exams and assignments                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |
| Thanhbinh                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Summer Research, another summer class, co-teaching a program on the week of 8/2 - 8/8                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |       |                            |                                                                               |             |